

Handout: Creating a Condemned

This adventure is for level 3 characters. Players can either create a new character or use one of the provided pregenerated characters.

If a player is creating a new character, they should follow these steps:

1. Determine Backstory

Each character starts as an inmate in the Cauldron, Capital's prison.

Players should consider the following questions about their character:

What special precautions are in place to keep the character from escaping their cell? If a player isn't sure, you can offer some suggestions: an antimagic field? Guards with earplugs to protect against magic or intense personal charm? Electrified or reinforced bars?

Prisoners are allowed to pursue a hobby or skill as long as they don't misbehave. **What is the character doing when the guards arrive?** Working out? Playing an instrument? Building a model? Or maybe you've never been cooperative enough to get a reward?

What is the character in for? Did they torch a tavern? Kill a hero? Pull off a heist?

How did they plead? Was the character set up? Did they take the fall to protect someone? Or are they as bad as everyone says, or even worse?

Note: The pregenerated characters in this adventure provide answers to some of these questions. As with any other aspect of these characters, these answers are just suggestions. Your players should feel free to rephrase, rewrite, or replace their characters' pregenerated backstories!

2. Choose a Complication

Villains tend to have outsized pasts. In a group of antiheroes, you can't throw a rock without hitting someone who made a deal with a fell entity, fell in a vat of acid, or otherwise had a brush with the sinister.

Although it's not required, each player can choose a complication (see Complications in *Draw Steel: Heroes*). They can also work with you to create a new complication, use one of the complications belonging to a pregenerated character, or use the complication below.

Sight of Blood

You like to dish out pain, not take it.

While you are bleeding or winded, your abilities that cost a heroic resource cost one less of that heroic resource (minimum 1) if they deal damage, and they cost one more heroic resource if they don't deal damage.

3. Create a Title

Many villains and antiheroes are driven by their ambitions and passions. They are motivated by a desire so strong—for power, revenge, carnage, riches, or another goal—that they are willing to go to any end to fulfill it.

Each player can choose a 1st echelon title (see Titles in *Draw Steel: Heroes*), one that speaks to their past adventures or their motivating desires. A player can also work with you to create a new title, use a title belonging to one of the pregenerated characters, or use the title below.

Everything Looks Like a Nail

"I've spent a lot of time honing this skill. Shame for all that effort to go to waste."

Prerequisite: Your compulsion to use a particular skill has gotten you into trouble.

Effect: Choose a skill when you gain this title. The first time each game session that you make a test using this skill, you gain a Hero Token. Additionally, you gain an edge whenever you make a test using this skill.

4. Choose a Downtime Ability

As a level 3 character, each Condemned has already survived several escapades before the start of this adventure (including the one that landed them in jail). To represent this history, give the character a benefit from the Learn from a Master downtime ability (see Downtime Projects in *Draw Steel: Heroes*), gaining the Acquire Ability, Improve Ability, or Improve Control benefit.